



brightness helped reveal more, the background was no longer black. Next up, the colour tests revealed slight tonal imbalance, which we must say plagued nearly all the TN panel-based LCDs, regardless of whether we've individually mentioned this or not. *F.E.A.R* saw some contrast issues, and a couple of issues of discolouration with certain darker hues like purple shadows, but overall nothing out of the ordinary. Both the games were sufficiently detailed and showed good overall effects. Our movie tests fared slightly better, and aside from a slight issue with insufficient contrast there were no other complaints. For Rs 10,500 the T201WA is cheap enough for a good home PC, or a multimedia and gaming PC, as long as you're not too discerning about quality. Its good build and typically industrial bulky looks will stand tall in the corporate environment as well.

Dell SP 2008 WFP

Features, looks and value—a rare combination

Looking exactly like its 'larger by two inches' brother, the SP 2008 WFP is a handsome monitor, and aside from the lack of an HDMI port has the same connectivity, build, and features. Sadly it's once again a glossy TN panel, albeit an excellent one. DisplayMate had minor issues with contrast on this panel. In fact we missed on a number of darker cards in the Intensity Check. Geometry tests were completed without any complaint, and even the reverse text tests went well. There were some issues with colour, but they weren't major, and mostly centred around its ability to produce certain intensities of green. The reds and blues were spot on. It did well in the gaming and movie tests proving its mettle as a serious multimedia option. The price of Rs 12,700 makes the SP 2008 WFP excellent value for



money and a terrific deal for any kind of audience. We'd just like a couple of quirks worked out—something both 20- and 22-inch siblings share.

Samsung 2053BW

Bordeaux's baby boy

A matte panel, a monitor with a body that can only be described as hot—the kind of hot that brings cold shivers of anticipation. Add to this exemplary build quality and you've got the 2053BW. DisplayMate was rather kind to this monitor and aside from the usual contrast issues (although not severe) the



geometry tests were a breeze. The 2053BW handles colours well, it's just not able to produce many more than its 6-bit TN panel's theoretical limit. Gaming is good on this monitor, and aside from the lack of contrast in some of the darkest areas of *F.E.A.R* it did well accurately reproducing all special effects, particle effects and explosions. The world of Tamriel comes to vivid life in *Oblivion*. With a good showing in the movie test as well, this monitor makes a good buy, except that its priced a little stiffly—Rs 14,500 is a little too much with the SP 2008 WFP breathing down its neck with identical performance at a lower price. The 22-inch panels are also

similarly priced, and two inches of real estate more for the same amount is a steal as well.

Samsung 2043 NXW

A touchy case

This is 2053BW's smaller brother in terms of price, but retaining the build quality and looks, and adding a touch control system that is quirky at times. A quick initial run of DisplayMate revealed issues beyond what its sibling had. We didn't get the full colour gamut, with noticeable flaws, and the contrast test was



just above what we'd consider acceptable. It has the same quality at geometry though. In gaming, the issue of contrast will be noticeable, although not quite so in movies, where for some reason we couldn't find much to gripe about. At Rs 12,500, it's cheaper than its sibling, but a let down in most other ways. We'd recommend shelling out Rs 2,000 more and crying once, instead of pinching your pockets and crying later.

17-inch LCD Monitors

Acer X173W

Featherweight pushover

Its light, with mediocre yet acceptable build quality. The lack of DVI is an annoyance as are the eyeglass buttons—large and ugly, the lower bezel pouts at you like a puffy lip. DisplayMate was its unkind self, and the little Acer huffs to keep up with the contrast and colour tests. It does manage to pass, though by a hairsbreadth. In games, the lack of an adequate contrast is noticeable. At Rs 8,500 the X173W is a good entry level monitor, suitable for a home PC and Internet use. Don't expect too much from this 17-inch, though.

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Dell 1708FP

A better stand we never did see

As the title says for a 17-inch monitor this one has a superlative stand that allows swivel, pivot and height adjustment, as well as portrait mode. Build quality is excellent too. It does have its fair share of problems, courtesy yet another TN panel, where a poor contrast ratio was seen in DisplayMate first, and *F.E.A.R* later. The fact that it's not a wide-screen doesn't make it any better, and the contrast ratio doesn't help either. We were somewhat mollified by the price (Rs 11,500) which makes it a slightly better option than the Acer X173W, since it outperforms it by 10 per cent.



HP L1710

A tad too expensive

The L1710 looks identical to the L2208W except it's not a wide-screen monitor. It has decent performance in DisplayMate, although the colour and contrast issues still remain. We did notice some serious discrepancies in the colour tests—particularly the 16-shade ramp test. In games and movies it per-



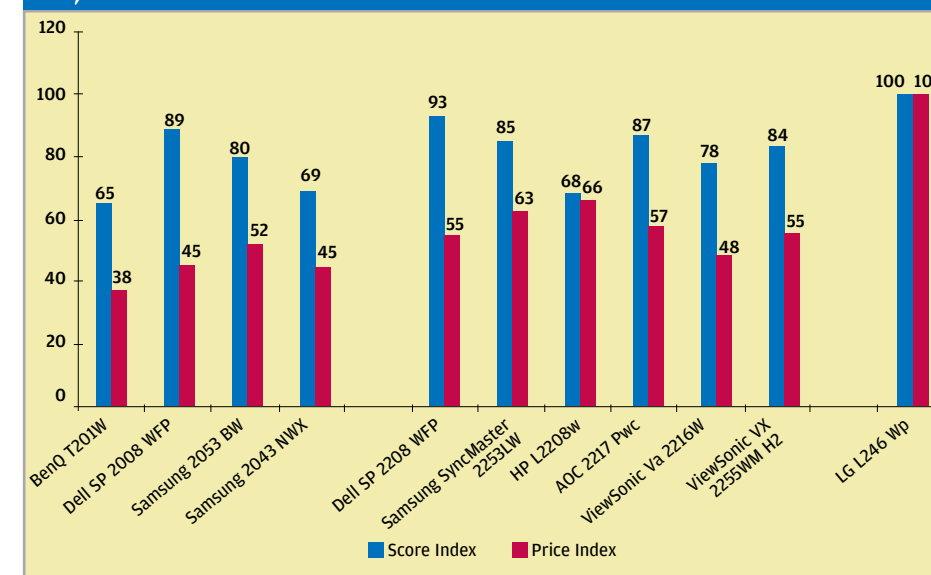
formed sub-par—a pity, because we expected more, especially for Rs 9,593.

Intex 1707 WBLK

Dances with wind

The L1707 is a good looking monitor featuring a glossy panel. Unfortunately, it took three minutes under our ceiling fan for us to realise this monitor actually shakes with a little breeze—courtesy a flimsy plastic stand, unlike its 19-inch sibling, which had a full metal stand. Performance was nothing worth writing home about, but we noticed no real issues

20, 22 and 24 inch Monitors



17 and 19 inch Monitors

